



tional Equities, says the acquisition of Tyco, a subsea cable system operator (in 2004 for \$130 million), was the first big pivot. It gave them a big play in data connectivity. “The next pivot was before the pandemic and marked the shift to a digital-first approach, leading to Tata Communications becoming a one-stop solution for multiple needs. That included next-gen connectivity solutions, cybersecurity solutions or move to cloud and specific solutions for the media vertical,” he explains. Importantly, in October 2024, the company announced that it would incorporate Nvidia software into its AI cloud offerings. These will be powered by Nvidia Hopper GPUs.

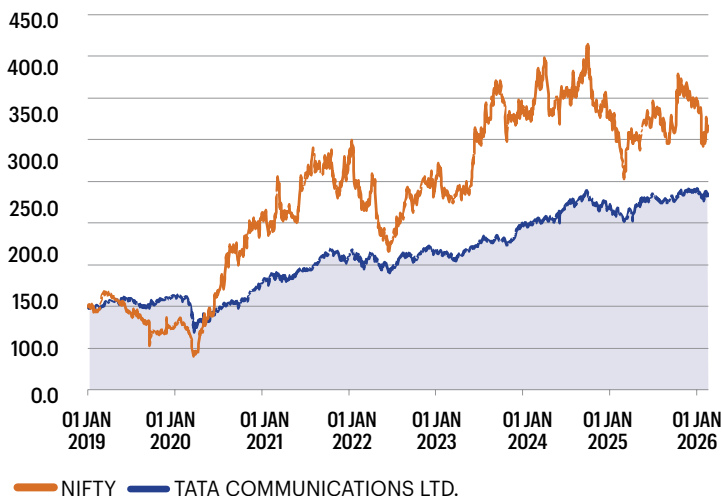
Tata Communications has also developed IoT, signalling that it does not want to be a pure-play IT company, and would rather position itself as a services player. “That seems rational given that companies work with several vendors on cloud, switches, CPaaS, among other things. CTOs realise the need to consolidate, making it a very attractive opportunity for Tata Communications,” he says. The hitch lies in the pace of technological change that can easily hamper a business model.

Walia sees Tata Communications facing a “once in a generation opportunity.” He looks back at some of the other big technological shifts to emphasise his point. “It took two decades for the internet and one decade for the mobile. Cloud took a decade, and now with AI and GenAI, that shift will be seen in the next three-four years,” he says.

All eyes will be on how the company will up its game from here on. Maybe it needs to disrupt itself once more, not for survival but just to get better. For Tata Communications, an interesting phase of growth has barely started to unfold. **BT**

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